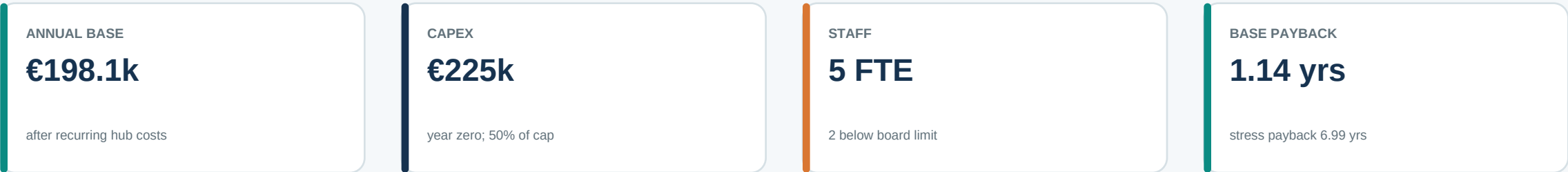


Approve CZE + ESP

with a 90-day evidence gate before full release

Highest modeled base-case annual contribution among options within the budget and staffing caps. Funding is conditional because transaction, site, labor and hub assumptions are synthetic and unvalidated.



RECOMMENDED BOARD ACTION

Authorize a conditional €225,000 capex envelope and five FTE for Czechia + Spain. Release spend in stages; stop or re-rank if live validation does not support the stated low case or if site costs exceed the option inputs.

Synthetic 2025 baseline: €2.03m contribution

1,254 eligible orders | 77,436 units | €4.384m net sales | 46.3% contribution margin



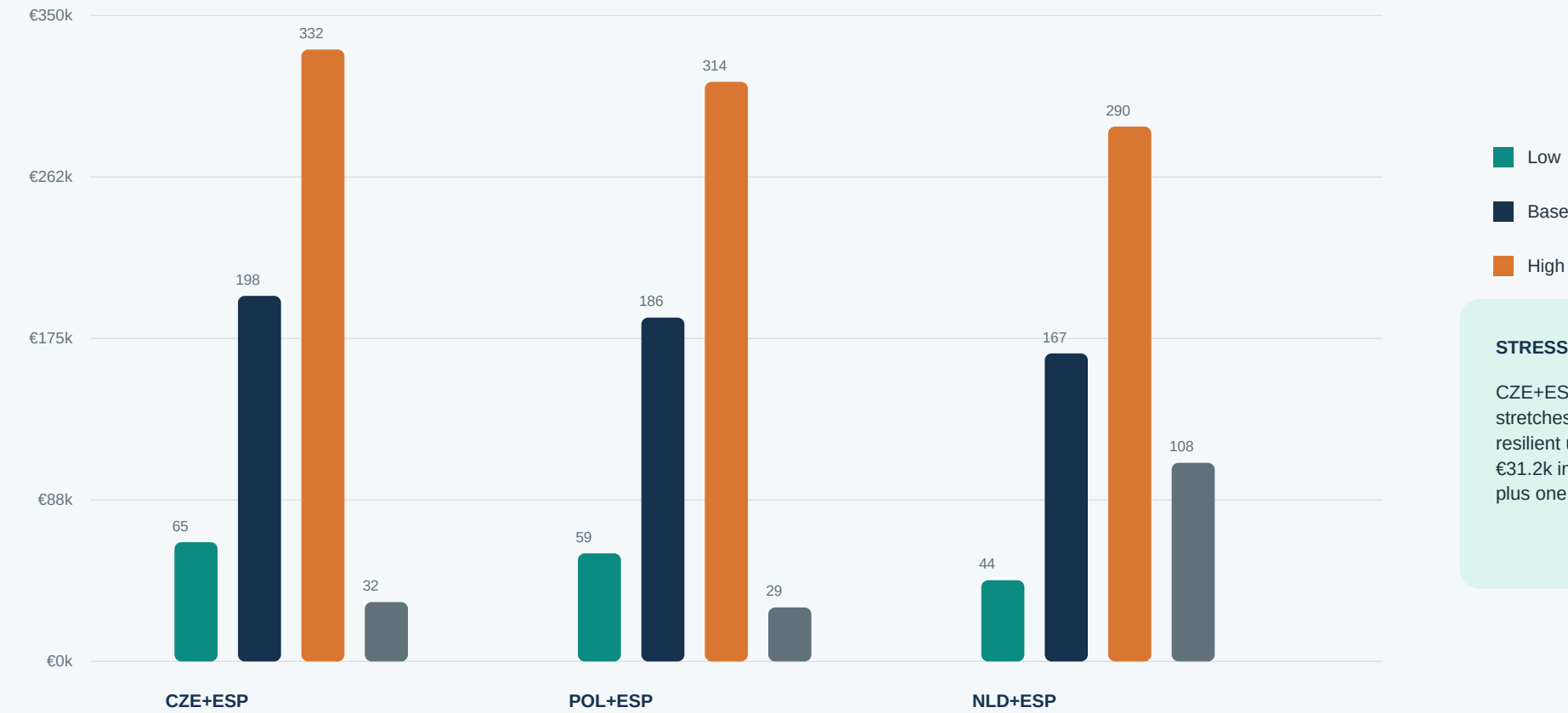
2025 COUNTRY SNAPSHOT

Market	Net sales	Contribution	Margin
DEU	€625.8k	€262.4k	41.9%
FRA	€632.2k	€276.3k	43.7%
NLD	€697.7k	€315.6k	45.2%
POL	€761.9k	€356.5k	46.8%
CZE	€815.3k	€397.3k	48.7%
ESP	€850.8k	€421.9k	49.6%

The generated input has exactly 209 eligible orders in each country. Market rank is an export description, not verified demand.

CZE + ESP leads the defined scenarios

Annual incremental contribution after recurring fixed costs; no probabilities assigned



STRESS IS NOT A FORECAST

CZE+ESP stress remains +€32.2k/year but stretches payback to ~7 years. NLD+ESP is more resilient under stress (+€107.6k) while giving up €31.2k in the base case and using €45k more capex plus one FTE.

The choice is sensitive to modest relative uplift differences

CZE + ESP is the base leader; rankings are estimates from synthetic planning assumptions

NEXT BASE-CASE ALTERNATIVE

POL + ESP

CZE+ESP is +€11.8k/year in base and +€2.9k in stress, while requiring €15k less capex and one fewer FTE. It is ahead in low, base, high and stress scenarios.

STRESS-RESILIENT ALTERNATIVE

NLD + ESP

Stress contribution is €107.6k/year vs €32.2k for CZE+ESP, at the cost of €31.2k lower base contribution, €45k more capex and one more FTE.

SWITCH CONDITION

CZE uplift threshold: 22.2%

Holding ESP and every other input constant, if the validated CZE volume uplift is below this threshold while POL reaches the policy's 25% base uplift, POL+ESP overtakes on modeled annual contribution. The supplied model assumes the same uplift across countries.

What could reverse the recommendation

Lower CZE order density or savings; higher actual site/fixed cost; staffing constraints; or a board preference for stress resilience rather than base-case return. Defer remains valid if validation fails.

No causal effect or statistical certainty is claimed. The scenario policy specifies assumptions, not observed hub outcomes.

90-day staged implementation

Functional owners are proposed; validate current operating data before committing to either site

DAY 0–30

VALIDATE

CFO / FP&A + Operations

Rebuild actual order/return baseline; verify uplift, savings, capex, fixed cost, FX and site shortlist.

Gate: CZE still beats POL+ESP at current inputs; no contract.

DAY 31–60

DESIGN

Procurement / Facilities + HR

Secure comparable quotations, staffing, lease/compliance review, inventory/returns workflow and staged terms.

Gate: five FTE feasible; capex ≤€225k; fixed cost ≤€95k/year.

DAY 61–90

PROVE

Regional Ops + Analytics

Pilot one site, then release the second only after economics and service check; weekly KPI review.

Gate: annualized gain ≥ low case (€64.6k) and customer-promise KPI holds.

WEEKLY KPI CONTROL

Volume ≥1.25× validated country run rate; realized savings ≥€2.10/unit CZE and €3.00/unit ESP; refund-to-gross ratio tracked with a +3pp stress trigger; capex ≤€225k; recurring fixed cost ≤€95k/year; service target ≥95% of quoted promise after live baseline is set. These are proposed gates, not measured client targets.

Board ask and evidence boundary

Recommendation is conditional; decision should reopen on measured input changes

APPROVE

CZE + ESP | €225k | 5 FTE

Authorize the envelope with staged release. Require Gate 1 validation of live country volume, site capex, annual fixed cost and savings before binding commitments. Require Gate 3 low-case annual contribution ≥€64.6k before completing the second-site release.

KEEP THE DECISION REVERSIBLE

If actual CZE uplift is below 22.2% while POL is at 25%, re-rank against POL+ESP. If downside resilience takes priority, compare NLD+ESP. If the low-case gate fails, defer.

EVIDENCE INCLUDED

Synthetic client order pages, corrections, returns, unit costs, hub assumptions and policy; archived official ECB 2025 reference rates; archived official World Bank 2022–2024 population and current-US\$ GDP per capita. Files, URLs and hashes are in the workbook/source register.

MATERIAL LIMITS

No live customer data, customer interviews, site quotes, contracts, causal test, probabilities, or real transaction FX. Current-dollar GDP and population do not prove product demand. No full discounted cash-flow or ramp model.

Raw source snapshot and reproducible scripts are delivered with this deck. Metrics and country-month detail are in meridian_analysis.xlsx and metrics.json.